UPSC CSAT Paper II — Hard Simulation 3

Date: 2026-10-04 | Maximum Marks: 200 | Time: 120 minutes

Topics: Comprehension | Numeracy & DI | Logical/Analytical Ability | Decision-making

INSTRUCTIONS:

- 80 objective questions; each carries 2.5 marks. Maximum marks: 200.
- Time allowed: 120 minutes. Qualifying benchmark: 33% of 200 under the notified scheme; verify the current notification.
- Negative marking: one-third of the marks assigned to a question for a wrong answer; blank answers carry no penalty.
- This question paper is answer-free. Use the separately supplied answer key and solutions only after submission.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 1 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 1. Discussions of community-based forest governance often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q1. The central contention developed in Passage 1 is that: Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q2. Reading Passage 1 closely, which inference is justified? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q3. Passage 1 would be weakened most directly if which assumption failed? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q4. The authorial stance in Passage 1 is: Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 2 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 2. Discussions of the use of evidence in welfare delivery often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q5. With reference to Passage 2, which one of the following best captures its central claim? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q6. Which one of the following is most directly inferable from Passage 2? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q7. Which one of the following assumptions is necessary for the argument in Passage 2? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q8. The tone of Passage 2 is best described as: Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 3 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 3. Discussions of school learning recovery often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q9. Passage 3 is principally arguing that: Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q10. Passage 3 most clearly permits which inference? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q11. The reasoning in Passage 3 depends on which assumption? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q12. Which description most accurately characterises the tone of Passage 3? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 4 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 4. Discussions of last-mile public health often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q13. Which interpretation most accurately states the main proposition of Passage 4? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q14. Which conclusion follows most securely from Passage 4? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q15. Which presupposition is required by the argument in Passage 4? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q16. Passage 4 adopts which overall rhetorical posture? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION A — COMPREHENSION — PASSAGE 5 (4 questions × 2.5 marks)

Passage 5. Discussions of transport planning and accessibility often begin with a choice between a uniform rule and complete decentralisation. That choice is misleading. Uniform standards can protect minimum entitlements, while local experimentation can reveal constraints invisible in a central design. The difficult part is the feedback loop: information from implementation must reach the decision-maker, and the decision-maker must be willing to revise an attractive but ineffective design. Evidence therefore does not replace values; it helps test whether chosen means are compatible with stated ends. A policy that reports activity without measuring access, distribution and unintended effects may look busy while learning very little. The prudent approach is neither blind uniformity nor romantic localism, but accountable adaptation.

Q17. The central contention developed in Passage 5 is that: Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q18. Reading Passage 5 closely, which inference is justified? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q19. Passage 5 would be weakened most directly if which assumption failed? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q20. The authorial stance in Passage 5 is: Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION B — NUMERACY AND DATA INTERPRETATION (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q21. If r is the remainder when 4^23 + 5^21 is divided by 12, what is r? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q22. How many integers from 3 through 92, inclusive, are divisible by 7 or 17, but not by both? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q23. Solution A contains 26% solute and solution B contains 16% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 8:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q24. Three independent teams complete a task in 12, 19 and 35 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q25. The average score of 19 candidates is 54. One score of 47 is replaced by 67. What is the new average? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q26. A quantity rises by 16%, falls by 17%, and then rises by 26%. What is the net percentage change? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q27. A rectangle of dimensions 19 m by 13 m has squares of side 2 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q28. A five-period index has values [7, 9, 11, 4, 6]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q29. How many multiples of lcm(12, 10) lie in the inclusive interval [63, 247]? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q30. A sequence begins [4, 7, 11, 14]. Its successive increments are 3, 4, 3, 4, ... What is the next term? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q31. If r is the remainder when 4^24 + 5^22 is divided by 14, what is r? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q32. How many integers from 1 through 102, inclusive, are divisible by 10 or 18, but not by both? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q33. Solution A contains 21% solute and solution B contains 13% solute. If A and B are mixed in the volume ratio 6:1, what is the resulting concentration? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q34. Three independent teams complete a task in 13, 18 and 32 days respectively. Working together at constant rates, how many days are required? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q35. The average score of 20 candidates is 53. One score of 44 is replaced by 77. What is the new average? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q36. A quantity rises by 10%, falls by 18%, and then rises by 26%. What is the net percentage change? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q37. A rectangle of dimensions 13 m by 11 m has squares of side 3 m removed from its four corners. What area remains? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q38. A five-period index has values [8, 10, 3, 5, 7]; corresponding weights are [2, 3, 4, 5, 6]. What is the remainder when the weighted total is divided by 17? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q39. How many multiples of lcm(10, 13) lie in the inclusive interval [133, 527]? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q40. A sequence begins [2, 5, 7, 10]. Its successive increments are 3, 2, 3, 2, ... What is the next term? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION C — LOGICAL REASONING AND ANALYTICAL ABILITY (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q41. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q42. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q43. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 5, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q44. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 4 members are in X, 6 additional members are in Y but not X, and 6 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q45. A field worker moves 6 km east and then 6 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q46. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q47. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q48. From 7 proposals, 3 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q49. A team records 4 wins, 3 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q50. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 7 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q51. Seven people A, B, C, D, E, F and G sit in a row. C is third from the left; A is left of D; B and F are non-adjacent; G is not at an end. Which person cannot occupy fifth position? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q52. Six candidates P, Q, R, S, T and U are ranked first to sixth. P is above R, R above U, S above R, Q below S, and T is not first. Which candidate cannot be third? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q53. In a coding rule, each letter is replaced by its position multiplied by 6, then 3 is added and the result is reduced modulo 26 (A=0). What code is assigned to the letter whose position is 7? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q54. All members of set X are in Y; no member of Y is in Z; exactly 6 members are in X, 6 additional members are in Y but not X, and 8 members are outside Y. How many members are in Y? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q55. A field worker moves 4 km east and then 6 km north. What is the straight-line distance from the starting point, ignoring the path taken? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q56. M is the sister of N. N is the father of P. P is the daughter of Q. Relative to P, what is M? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q57. Exactly one of A, B and C is guilty and exactly one statement is true. A says B is guilty; B says A and C are innocent; C says B is innocent. Who is guilty? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q58. From 7 proposals, 4 are selected. Two specified proposals cannot be selected together. How many selections are possible? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q59. A team records 6 wins, 4 draws and 2 losses. With 3 points for a win, 1 for a draw and 0 for a loss, what is its points total? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q60. A committee must choose an ordered pair of distinct coordinators from 7 eligible members. How many ordered pairs are possible? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

SECTION D — DECISION-MAKING AND PROBLEM SOLVING (20 questions × 2.5 marks)

Choose the most appropriate answer. Only one option is correct.

Q61. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A new digital process excludes some intended users. What should the officer do first? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q62. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. Two agencies submit conflicting records before a time-sensitive public intervention. What is the soundest next step? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q63. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A service reports high activity, but users say their underlying problems remain unresolved. Which measure should follow? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q64. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A fund can support a visible ceremony or a tested low-cost intervention. Which decision is stronger? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q65. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A lowest bid has a minor clerical error but no evidence of material advantage. What is fairest? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q66. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A measurement conflicts with credible user reports before a sanction is proposed. What should precede action? Use the hill-health register as the complete information set for this question.

Q67. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A public message must announce an uncertain hazard. Which communication is most responsible? Use the ration audit as the complete information set for this question.

Q68. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. Scarce services must be allocated between a larger population and a higher untreated-need rate. What rule is soundest? Use the tank-restoration file as the complete information set for this question.

Q69. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A performance target encourages staff to close cases without resolving them. What correction is best? Use the hostel attendance sheet as the complete information set for this question.

Q70. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A vocal association claims to represent everyone, but consultation attendance is narrow. What should follow? Use the river-route log as the complete information set for this question.

Q71. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A pilot produces mixed results across neighbourhoods. How should the administrator respond? Use the border-connectivity map as the complete information set for this question.

Q72. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A grievance channel receives fewer complaints after a redesign. What is the most careful interpretation? Use the vending-permit register as the complete information set for this question.

Q73. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A contractor asks to relax a safety condition to meet a deadline. What should the officer do? Use the safety-inspection file as the complete information set for this question.

Q74. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A beneficiary list contains duplicate names and some genuine exclusions. What is the right sequence? Use the forest-response dashboard as the complete information set for this question.

Q75. In a border village, a file concerning mobile-network access is being reviewed by service administrators; the available evidence includes coverage and complaint logs. A local leader requests an exception for one influential applicant. What is defensible? Use the school-recovery ledger as the complete information set for this question.

Q76. In a small municipality, a file concerning street-vending permits is being reviewed by licensing staff; the available evidence includes permit and footfall records. A new digital process excludes some intended users. What should the officer do first? Use the municipal works map as the complete information set for this question.

Q77. In a small municipality, a file concerning street-vending permits is being reviewed by licensing staff; the available evidence includes permit and footfall records. Two agencies submit conflicting records before a time-sensitive public intervention. What is the soundest next step? Use the clinic-referral diary as the complete information set for this question.

Q78. In a small municipality, a file concerning street-vending permits is being reviewed by licensing staff; the available evidence includes permit and footfall records. A service reports high activity, but users say their underlying problems remain unresolved. Which measure should follow? Use the market-access survey as the complete information set for this question.

Q79. In a small municipality, a file concerning street-vending permits is being reviewed by licensing staff; the available evidence includes permit and footfall records. A fund can support a visible ceremony or a tested low-cost intervention. Which decision is stronger? Use the ward-grievance register as the complete information set for this question.

Q80. In a small municipality, a file concerning street-vending permits is being reviewed by licensing staff; the available evidence includes permit and footfall records. A lowest bid has a minor clerical error but no evidence of material advantage. What is fairest? Use the coastal-service ledger as the complete information set for this question.

— END OF QUESTION PAPER —

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